

3. Journalistic writers are the third species of freelance writers. They are different from the other two in that they often aim/claim to be impartial and reliable sources of information. They do not actively hunt prey to survive, as the prey are naturally attracted to them by virtue of their coverage of important and/or exclusive events and happenings. Members of this species often compete amongst themselves on the grounds of timeliness, and collect credibility like squirrels hoard acorns.
4. A species similar to journalistic writers are the technical writers, sometimes referred to as instructional writers. Their similarity is on account of their characteristic of providing reliable information, although technical writers have a diet of prey that is harder to hunt. Also, they operate in extreme environments and thus have to be precise and methodical to survive.
5. The final and most elusive type of freelance writer is the ghost writer. The behavioural patterns of this species is largely unknown, but one of the facts that have been observed till date are its sporadic but ravenous appetite. Another intriguing feature is their practice of wearing the hide of other animals as disguise.

## Finding work

As with any freelance profession, a freelance writer needs to find his/her own clients until they are good enough that clients go looking for them. Assuming you have the ability and confidence to do the job, you still need to find someone who needs the job done. Here's where technology makes life so much easier - the internet is the ultimate hunting ground. The terrain is flat and accessible, watering holes are abundant with prey aplenty, and best of all, everything is within reach for anyone with an internet connection. What's more, your prey isn't even trying to hide, which makes the hunting metaphor somewhat inapplicable, but let's go with it anyway.

First step - reconnaissance. Scan the terrain. Study the most efficient hunting techniques of other hunters, maybe join a pack till you level up. Locate the most populous watering holes, identify the most nutritious prey. If you're part lucky and part attentive, you might find some plants that you can feed on, which flower and fruit periodically. Put bluntly, read what you want to write, and learn to recognize what makes good 'good'. Learn to recognize quality.

Second step - practice. Start with young ones, old ones, sick ones, slow ones, anything that you can get your teeth in. Even when you aren't suc-